# 5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 8 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** $8^3$
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** November 2, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature)
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Recognize, isolate, and contrast the structural frameworks, line mechanics, and auditory properties of diverse poetic forms (traditional metered verse versus free verse).
- **Topic:** Introduction to Poetry – Structural Mechanics of Ballads and Free Verse
- **Previous Knowledge:** Students have read Chapters 1–6 of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson and can discuss setting, character and the order of events. Many know Jamaican folk songs that tell stories.

## Key Vocabulary

**Key Vocabulary (word wall)**

**Stanza:** a group of lines in a poem, separated by a blank space

**Meter:** the regular beat in a line of poetry; the beat you can clap to

**Rhyme scheme:** the pattern of rhyming words at the ends of lines, shown with letters (e.g. ABCB)

**Ballad:** a poem that tells a story, usually with a regular rhythm and rhyme, often meant to be sung

**Free verse:** poetry with no regular rhyme scheme or meter; it follows natural speech

## Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

***Cognitive***

1. After the Explain phase, students will identify examples of stanza, meter, rhyme scheme, ballad and free verse in Excerpt A or Excerpt B, correctly identifying at least four of the five terms.
2. Using the Structural Comparison Matrix, students will contrast the ballad and the free verse poem across at least three features (stanza count, rhyme scheme and metric regularity).

***Affective***

3. While working in pairs, students will share the annotation tasks, with each partner annotating at least one of the two excerpts.

***Psychomotor***

4. Using their pens, students will write the rhyme scheme letters (e.g. ABCB) beside every line of Excerpt A, with all three stanzas labelled correctly.

## Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Define and compare ballad and free verse structures; decode rhyme scheme notation (e.g. AABB vs. ABCB).
- **Affective:** Value poetic variety as a way of telling stories; respect the sound of different poetic forms.
- **Psychomotor:** Use pen marks to bracket, circle and label lines and rhyming words.

## Learning Styles

- **Visual:** Bracketed stanzas and the comparison matrix on the board.
- **Auditory:** Choral reading, hand-clapping the beat.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Clapping the beat; marking the handouts.

## Resources

- Week 7 Resource Pack (Resources 1–6): printable handouts, answer key and exit tickets
- "Linstead Market" folk song and the Chapter 2 passage, page 16 (in Engage below)
- Excerpt A – "The Wreck of the Hesperus" (Longfellow) and Excerpt B – "Fog" (Sandburg) (in Explore below)
- Marking key and pair role slips (in Explore below)
- Structural Comparison Matrix (in Elaborate below)
- KWL charts and exit tickets
- PowerPoint (with a recording of "Linstead Market") and whiteboard

## NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Compare and contrast the elements and authors of various literary genres (e.g. short story, novel, drama, fable, fantasy, biography, documentary, poetry, and science-fiction). *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Structural Comparison Matrix and Exit Ticket Q2 (how a ballad differs from free verse).*
- Analyse poetry to identify and comment on the effectiveness of the use of the ballad and free verse poetic forms. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 2, Unit 2). Checked by: Exit Ticket Q1 and Q3 (stanza and rhyme scheme); KWL chart, L column.*

*Sequencing note: the ballad and free verse objective is listed for Term 2, Unit 2. This lesson introduces it early through the Term 1 genre-comparison objective (Term 1, Unit 1), so students compare the novel with poetry now and are ready for the full poetry unit in Term 2.*

## Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage and Evaluate – prior knowledge at the start; what students learned at the end.
- **Kinaesthetic Rhythm Activity:** Engage – students clap the beat of a folk verse.

- **Compare and Contrast:** Engage – verse rhythm vs. natural prose from Chapter 2.
- **Paired Reading Aloud with Role Slips:** Explore – pairs read Excerpt A and Excerpt B aloud.
- **Annotation with Pen Marks:** Explore – brackets for stanzas, circles for rhyming words.
- **Teacher Modelling:** Explain – mapping an ABCB rhyme scheme.
- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Comparison Matrix (Graphic Organizer):** Elaborate – Structural Comparison Matrix.
- **Differentiated Instruction:** Elaborate – guided checklists for target tiers.
- **Peer Review (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – pairs check another pair's matrix.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – short written check on poetic structure.

## Subject Integration

- **Music (Engage):** Students clap the beat of the Jamaican folk song "Linstead Market" and learn that many folk songs are ballads, because they tell a story.
- **History and Caribbean Culture (Explain):** Students learn that ballads were passed on by word of mouth before most people could read, which is why they rhyme and repeat.

## Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in pairs facing the whiteboard; the teacher claps the "Linstead Market" beat as an extra attention signal. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

## Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.
- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.
- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.

## Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** The teacher sings or chants "Linstead Market" while clapping; the poems and matrix are printed, and the rhyme scheme is modelled on the whiteboard.

## 5E PROCEDURE

## 1. ENGAGEMENT (10 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** Students fill in the K and W columns of their KWL chart about poems and songs. The teacher asks: "What songs or poems do you know that tell a story?" and "How is the way Rami tells his story in the novel different from the way a song tells a story?" The teacher writes the answers on the board and returns to them in Explain.

**KWL Chart: Poems and Songs (one per student)**

| K – What I Know | W – What I Want to Know | L – What I Learned |
|---|---|---|
| *e.g. Some poems rhyme.* | *e.g. Do all poems have to rhyme?* | *(Completed in Evaluate)* |

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will listen to a folk verse and clap firmly on every strong beat. They then contrast this rhythm with a natural conversational passage from Chapter 2, discuss the difference between words in a musical pattern and words that flow freely, and record the term Poetic Meter.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will recite the verse with rhythmic handclapping, read the prose passage in a natural voice, and guide the discussion. The teacher will ask:
- Which reading was easier to clap along to? Why?
- Which one sounded more like people talking?

**Key Definition**

**Poetic meter:** the regular pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables in a line of poetry; the "beat" you can clap to.

**Folk Verse: "Linstead Market" (traditional Jamaican folk song)**

Carry mi ackee go a Linstead Market,
Not a quattie wut sell.
Carry mi ackee go a Linstead Market,
Not a quattie wut sell.

Lawd, wat a night, not a bite,
Wat a Satiday night!
Lawd, wat a night, not a bite,
Wat a Satiday night!

**Word help:** ackee – Jamaica's national fruit; quattie – an old coin worth a penny and a half; Satiday – Saturday.

**Prose Passage: My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson, Chapter 2 (page 16)**

"Where's your saddle, old man?" they said. "You too poor to afford one?"

And they laughed again.

I didn't answer. I didn't cry. I knew I shouldn't cry. But it was hard.

*Read in a natural speaking voice. Students try to clap along and notice there is no regular beat.*

- **Subject Integration (Music):** Students clap the beat of "Linstead Market" and learn that many folk songs are ballads, because they tell a story.
- **Technology (in class):** The teacher plays a recording of "Linstead Market" from the PowerPoint or a phone and speaker so students hear the beat before they clap.
- **Formative Check:** Students show thumbs up, sideways or down for "I can hear the beat." The teacher claps the verse again with any student showing thumbs down.

*(Auditory & Kinaesthetic)*

## 2. EXPLORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work in pairs to read Excerpt A and Excerpt B aloud. Using their pens, pairs draw brackets around each block of lines (stanzas), circle the final word of every line, and draw lines joining words with matching end sounds.

**Marking Key (use your blue or black pen)**

| Mark | What to mark |
|---|---|
| Brackets [ ] | Around each block of lines (stanzas) |
| Circle and join | Circle the final word of every line; draw a line joining words with matching end sounds |
| Letters | Rhyme scheme letters (A, B, C…) beside each line (used in Explain) |

**Excerpt A: "The Wreck of the Hesperus" by Henry Wadsworth Longfellow (ballad)**

It was the schooner Hesperus,
That sailed the wintry sea;
And the skipper had taken his little daughter,
To bear him company.

The skipper he stood beside the helm,
His pipe was in his mouth,
And he watched how the veering flaw did blow
The smoke now West, now South.

Then up and spake an old Sailor,
Had sailed to the Spanish Main,
"I pray thee, put into yonder port,
For I fear a hurricane."

**Word help:** schooner – a sailing ship; skipper – the captain; helm – the wheel that steers the ship; flaw – a sudden gust of wind; spake – spoke; yonder – over there; the Spanish Main – the Caribbean coast of Central and South America.

**Excerpt B: "Fog" by Carl Sandburg (free verse)**

The fog comes
on little cat feet.

It sits looking
over harbor and city
on silent haunches
and then moves on.

**Word help:** haunches – the back legs of an animal when it sits.

**Pair Role Slips (swap for Excerpt B) (cut out; give one slip to each group member)**

| ✂️ **Reader** | ✂️ **Marker** |
| --- | --- |
| Read the excerpt aloud, pausing at the end of each line. | Bracket the stanzas, circle the last words and join the rhymes. |

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the excerpts and check that pairs find the stanza blocks and the rhyming end words.
- **Formative Check:** The teacher circulates with a checklist (stanzas bracketed? rhymes circled and joined?) and ticks off each pair's progress.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "You bracketed stanza 1 correctly. Now find where stanza 2 ends; look for the blank space."

*(Visual & Kinaesthetic)*

## 3. EXPLANATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will study the marked rhymes on their handouts, noticing that Excerpt A follows a fixed pattern while Excerpt B changes shape freely. They copy the definitions and practise writing the letters A, B, C, B beside the lines modelled on the board.

**Key Definitions (students copy into notebooks)**

**Stanza:** a group of lines in a poem, separated from other groups by a blank space (like a paragraph in prose).

**Rhyme scheme:** the pattern of rhyming words at the ends of lines, shown with letters. Lines that rhyme get the same letter (e.g. ABCB: only lines 2 and 4 rhyme).

**Ballad:** a poem that tells a story, usually in four-line stanzas with a regular rhythm and rhyme scheme (often ABCB), and often meant to be sung.

**Free verse:** poetry with no regular rhyme scheme or meter; it follows the rhythm of natural speech.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will display and explain the definitions, and model how to map an ABCB rhyme scheme using lines from Excerpt A.

**Teacher Answers: Rhyme Scheme of Excerpt A**

Every stanza follows ABCB: lines 2 and 4 rhyme (sea / company; mouth / South; Main / hurricane), and lines 1 and 3 do not. Excerpt B has no rhyme scheme.

**Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)**

1. Analyse: Why do you think ballads were used to tell stories before most people could read?
2. Compare: Which poem would be easier to remember and sing? Why?
3. Evaluate: Which form suits a story about a storm at sea better, a ballad or free verse? Justify your answer.
4. Create: How would "Fog" change if it rhymed? Rewrite its first two lines so they rhyme.

*Guide answers: rhyme and a regular beat make ballads easy to memorise and pass on by word of mouth; the ballad is easier to sing; accept either form if the reason is supported; a rhyming "Fog" would sound more like a song and less like natural speech.*

- **Subject Integration (History and Caribbean Culture):** Students learn that ballads were passed on by word of mouth before most people could read, which is why they rhyme and repeat.
- **Technology (in class):** Excerpt A is shown on a PowerPoint slide; the teacher copies the first stanza onto the whiteboard and writes the ABCB letters beside it while students follow on their handouts.

- **Formative Check:** The teacher points to a line and students hold up fingers to show its rhyme letter (1 = A, 2 = B, 3 = C).

*(Visual & Auditory)*

## 4. ELABORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the Structural Comparison Matrix in pairs, comparing both poems by stanza count, rhyme scheme, metric regularity and tone.

**Structural Comparison Matrix**

| Feature | Excerpt A (ballad) | Excerpt B (free verse) |
|---|---|---|
| Stanza count | | |
| Rhyme scheme | | |
| Metric regularity | | |
| Tone | | |

- **Differentiation Support:** Supported pairs use handouts with the rhyming end words already underlined and the lines numbered.
- **Differentiation Extension:** Extended pairs write a four-line ballad stanza with an ABAB rhyme scheme, then rewrite the same message as four lines of free verse.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the matrices, monitor how pairs share the work, and give guided checklists to target tiers.

**Teacher Answers: Structural Comparison Matrix**

**Stanza count:** A – 3 stanzas of 4 lines; B – 2 stanzas (2 lines and 4 lines).

**Rhyme scheme:** A – ABCB in every stanza; B – no rhyme scheme.

**Metric regularity:** A – a regular beat you can clap to; B – no regular beat; it follows natural speech.

**Tone:** A – tense, worried or dramatic (a storm is coming); B – calm, quiet or peaceful. Accept any tone word students can support.

- **Numeracy Link:** Students count the stanzas, the lines in each stanza and the beats in one line of Excerpt A, then work out what fraction of the lines rhyme in each stanza (2 out of 4 = ½).
- **Peer Assessment:** Each pair swaps its completed matrix with another pair, checks it against the answers on the board, and writes one star (something correct) and one wish (something to fix).
- **Feedback:** The teacher reviews one matrix with the whole class, praising specific correct answers and correcting common mistakes.

*(Visual & Kinaesthetic)*

## 5. EVALUATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete a short written check on their own, then complete the L column of the KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the matrices, make sure students answer the exit ticket on their own, and collect the slips at the end of the 10 minutes.

**Exit Ticket**

1. What do we call a group of lines in a poem that is separated by a blank space?
2. Explain the main difference between a traditional ballad and free verse.
3. In a four-line stanza, line 2 ends with "night" and line 4 ends with "light". Lines 1 and 3 do not rhyme. What is the rhyme scheme?

**Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket**

1. A stanza. 2. A ballad tells a story with a regular rhyme scheme and rhythm (often ABCB); free verse has no regular rhyme scheme or meter and follows natural speech. 3. ABCB.

- **Self-Assessment:** Students rate each statement with a traffic light.

**Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)**

| I can… | Green | Yellow | Red |
|---|---|---|---|
| identify a stanza, meter, rhyme scheme, ballad and free verse | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| label a rhyme scheme (e.g. ABCB) | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| compare a ballad and a free verse poem | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| work well with a partner | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

*Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.*

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "A ballad is different from free verse because…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises specific effort (e.g. "This pair found every rhyme in stanza 3") and awards class points to pairs who worked well together.

*(Visual & Auditory)*

**Total: 10 + 15 + 10 + 15 + 10 = 60 minutes**

## Homework / Extension Assignment (Graded – 20 marks): My Ballad and Free Verse Poem

Write your own poem about something that happened in your community, at school or at home (for example, a market day, a storm, a football match or a family event).

- **Part A – Ballad:** write 2 stanzas of 4 lines each that tell the story, using an ABCB rhyme scheme. Write the rhyme scheme letters beside each line.
- **Part B – Free verse:** tell the same story again in 4 to 6 lines of free verse, with no rhyme scheme and no regular beat.
- **Title and due date:** give the poem a title; due at the next literature lesson.
- **Support:** students may begin with the frame "It was a ____ day in ____, / When ____ …"

***Grading Criteria: My Ballad and Free Verse Poem (20 marks)***

| Criteria | What is expected | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| **Ballad form** | 2 stanzas of 4 lines each, separated by a blank line | 4 |
| **Rhyme scheme** | Lines 2 and 4 rhyme in each stanza (ABCB), with the letters labelled correctly | 4 |
| **Storytelling** | The ballad tells a clear story with a beginning, a middle and an end | 4 |
| **Free verse** | The same story in 4–6 lines, with no rhyme scheme or regular beat | 4 |
| **Language and presentation** | Title included; correct spelling and punctuation; neat work | 4 |
| **Total** | | **20** |

***Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)***

- **Google Classroom:** Post Excerpts A and B and today's definitions so students can review them at home.
- **Quizizz:** Assign an optional practice quiz on stanzas, rhyme schemes, ballads and free verse.

## Assessment Summary

| Type | What is assessed |
|---|---|
| **Diagnostic** | KWL chart (K and W); clapping activity and the meter vs. speech discussion. |
| **Formative** | Marked excerpts, thumbs and finger checks, the Structural Comparison Matrix and peer review; Quizizz practice report. |
| **Summative** | Exit ticket; My Ballad and Free Verse Poem (20 marks). |

## Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can identify a stanza, label a simple rhyme scheme correctly, and explain one difference between a ballad and free verse.

## Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 7 – Mid-Term Test (Chapters 1–6), after the mid-term review in Week 6.
- **Next:** Week 9 – Imagery and theme in Stephen Spender's "My Parents".

## APA References


- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.
- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.


## Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)

**What went well:**

_____

_____

**What to improve:**

_____

_____

**Students who need follow-up:**

_____